## ETHICS

The Jain ethic is a direct consequence of the philosophy of soul and *karma.* Since the primary duty of man is the evolution and perfection of his soul and that of his fellow creatures, *ahimsa,* or nonhurting of life, irrespective of its distinction into higher and lower, is the cardinal principle. "Hurt no one" is a positive injunction enjoining love and compassion toward all creatures; Jains alone build asylums and rest houses for old and diseased animals, where they are kept and fed until they die a natural death. The three ideals of *Samyag-Darsha* (right faith), *Samyag-Jyana* (right knowledge), and *Samyag-Charitra* (right conduct) are known as the three jewels, or the *triratna.*

Jainism also prescribes most elaborate rules for everyday conduct; for example, for guidance in the practice of *ahimsa,* cruelty is analyzed into as many as nine kinds, each subtler than the last.

## LOGIC

A distinctive contribution of Jainism lies in its doctrine of *naya,* which means "point of view." According to Jainism, the Buddhist doctrine of change and of nothingness, which postulates that all things are transitory, was contrary to facts, and so was the Advaitic theory of absolute identity. Their foremost logical position is what is called *Anekantavada,* or the theory of many-sidedness of reality and truth.

## ART AND ARCHITECTURE

Not believing in a god or *avataras* (incarnations of a god) the Jains are necessarily not an idol-worshiping sect, but this has not prevented them from erecting and carving statues in honor of their *siddhas,* or perfect souls. They have erected monumental *stupas* (hemispherical domes of solid masonry, surrounded by railings with ceremonial gateways and surmounted by an umbrella) in honor of their saints, and the richness and quality of their architecture and carving in stone have few equals. Excellent examples exist in Junagadh, Osmanabad and Girnar (just east of Junagadh, Saurashtra), while Mt. Abu in Rajasthan represents in its highest perfection the Indian genius for graceful masonry decoration. Satrunjaya (near Palitana, Saurashtra) is one of the world's most beautiful temple cities.